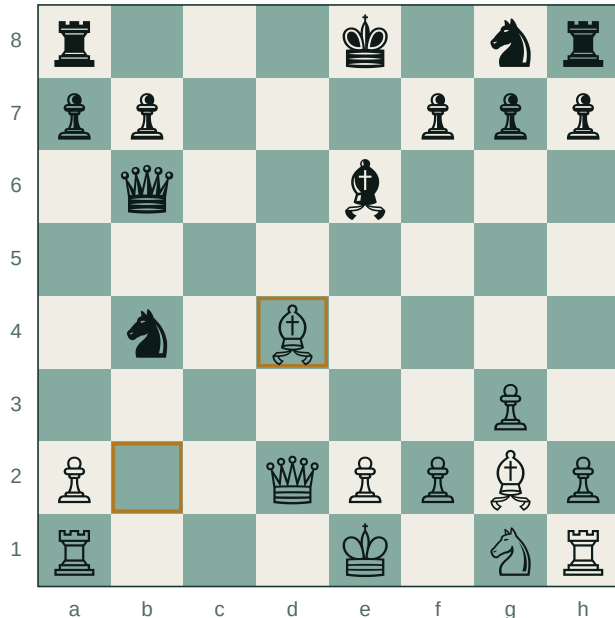


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 13

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 13.Bxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13...Qxd4 14. Qxd4 Nc2+ 15. Kf1 Nxd4

13...Qxd4 The queen captures the bishop on d4. From d4 it attacks queen on d2 and rook on a1. Recorded reply: **14.Qxd4**.

14...Nc2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From c2 it attacks king on e1, queen on d4 and rook on a1. Recorded reply: **15.Kf1**.

15...Nxd4 The knight captures the queen on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on g2. Check for tactical protection.